

20-Minute Workflow Bottleneck Scorecard

Compare recurring operational workflows, surface control issues and choose one evidence-backed starting point.

What this helps you do

Use a consistent set of factors to separate the loudest problem from the best bounded workflow to review next. A valid result can be to simplify, gather evidence or not proceed.

Companion workbook

Open **workflow-bottleneck-scorecard.xlsx** to enter ratings, use formulas and keep a working copy in an approved location.

Information boundary

Use general, synthetic or appropriately de-identified examples. Do not enter participant, patient, worker, clinical, credential or other personal or sensitive information into a public download or unapproved system.

QUICK START

Run the scorecard in 20 minutes

1	0-3 minutes: choose the list Write up to 12 recurring non-clinical workflows. Name the work, not the tool: for example, service commencement action tracking or monthly reporting preparation.
2	3-8 minutes: agree evidence Use direct observation, records and staff input where available. Separate verified facts from assumptions and opinions.
3	8-16 minutes: rate consistently Rate frequency, effort, handoffs, delay, rework, visibility, feasibility and evidence confidence from 1 to 5 using the same definitions.
4	16-20 minutes: apply the control gate Do not treat a high score as ready if sensitive information, high-stakes decisions, unclear authority or other controls need review.

Four scoring rules

- + Score the current workflow, not the hoped-for future state.
- + Use one workflow boundary with a clear start and end.
- + Do not assume automation is the answer; process, ownership or status design may be enough.
- + Record uncertainty. Evidence confidence is deliberately part of the score.

Strong result

You leave with one workflow to examine next, the reason it matters, the evidence still needed and any control issue that must be resolved first.

SCORING MODEL

Rate each factor from 1 to 5

Factor	Weight	1 - lower	3 - moderate	5 - higher
Frequency	15%	Monthly or less	Several times a week	Daily or many times a day
Staff effort	15%	A few minutes	Noticeable manual work	Large repeated effort across roles
Handoffs	10%	One owner	Several roles or systems	Many transfers; ownership unclear
Delay impact	15%	Minor and recoverable	Affects planning or follow-up	Materially disrupts operations
Error / rework	10%	Rare or easy to correct	Regular checking or re-entry	Frequent or material correction
Visibility gap	15%	Status and next action clear	Manual checking needed	Owner, status or next action unclear
Change feasibility	15%	Near-term change difficult	Some approvals or redesign	Bounded change appears practical
Evidence confidence	5%	Mostly assumption	Some corroboration	Strong direct evidence

Formula

Weighted score = each 1-5 rating multiplied by its visible weight, divided by 5 and rounded to a score out of 100. The weights support comparison; they are not an industry benchmark or predicted return.

Evidence confidence matters

A high-friction workflow based mainly on assumption should usually move into evidence gathering before solution design.

DECISION GUIDE

Read the result through a control gate

Signal	Meaning	Practical next action
75-100, no control flag	Strong candidate for a bounded review.	Validate the boundary, evidence, owner and desired result.
55-74, no control flag	Potential candidate with unresolved scope or feasibility.	Clarify the process and collect evidence before committing.
Below 55	Lower relative priority or weak evidence.	Keep watching, simplify first or choose a stronger workflow.
Any control flag	Sensitive information, high-stakes decisions or uncertainty may change what is safe and feasible.	Do not treat as implementation-ready. Review information, authority and controls.

A high score is not a business case

Before changing a workflow, confirm the current-state evidence, accountable owner, desired operating result, dependencies, information boundary, affected people and how acceptance will be tested.

No-build is a valid outcome

Keep an existing tool when it works. Remove unnecessary steps before automating. Use a process-only change when ownership or rules are the real constraint.

SERVICE BRIDGE

Choose the smallest useful next step

What the scorecard reveals	Possible route	Important boundary
The priority, root cause, workflow boundary or feasible option is still unclear.	Heutrix Diagnostics may help create a decision-ready implementation brief.	Diagnostics is a paid, standalone decision product and may recommend no build.
One bounded workflow and desired result are already clear and feasible.	A Heutrix Workflow Transformation scope may be worth discussing.	Scope, systems, access, acceptance, timing and price are confirmed in writing.
The issue is workplace AI use, information boundaries or accountable review.	Use the AI Guardrails Staff Starter Pack, then assess whether Heutrix AI Guardrails is needed.	The starter pack is not organisational approval or professional advice.
Evidence or ownership is too weak.	Gather evidence, clarify ownership or simplify before buying anything.	A no-project outcome is acceptable.

Use it without giving up your email

The workbook provides the full scoring method and immediate result. If you later want to discuss one high-level, non-sensitive workflow, the website route is 'See where Heutrix can help' for a 20-minute, no-obligation workflow fit call.

Do not send sensitive detail

A general description of what starts the work, which roles are involved, where status or handover becomes unclear and what a useful result would look like is enough for an initial conversation.